

IELTS

20

Academic

剑桥雅思官方真题集

Authentic Practice Tests 学术类

Test2–listening–part1

Questions 1–10

Complete the table below.

Write **ONE WORD AND/OR A NUMBER** for each answer.

Local councils can arrange practical support to help those caring for elderly people at home.

This can give the carer:

- time for other responsibilities
- a 1

Assessment of mother's needs

This may include discussion of:

- how much 2 the caring involves
- what types of tasks are involved, e.g.
 - help with dressing
 - helping her have a 3
 - shopping
 - helping with meals
 - dealing with 4

- any aspects of caring that are especially difficult, e.g.
 - loss of 5
 - 6 her
 - preventing a 7

Types of support that may be offered to carers

- transport costs, e.g. cost of a 8
- car-related costs, e.g. fuel and 9
- help with housework
- help to reduce 10

Test2–listening–part2

Questions 11–16

What is the role of the volunteers in each of the following activities?

Choose **SIX** answers from the box and write the correct letter, **A–I**, next to

Questions 11–16.

- walking around the town centre
- helping at concerts
- getting involved with community groups
- helping with a magazine
- participating at lunches for retired people
- helping with the website

- A. providing entertainment
- B. providing publicity about a council service
- C. contacting local businesses
- D. giving advice to visitors
- E. collecting feedback on events
- F. selling tickets
- G. introducing guest speakers at an event
- H. encouraging cooperation between local organisations
- I. helping people find their seats

Questions 17-20

Choose the correct letter, **A**, **B** or **C**.

17 Which event requires the largest number of volunteers?

- A.the music festival
- B.the science festival
- C.the book festival

18 What is the most important requirement for volunteers at the festivals?

- A.interpersonal skills
- B.personal interest in the event
- C.flexibility

19 New volunteers will start working in the week beginning

- A.2 September.
- B.9 September.
- C.23 September.

20 What is the next annual event for volunteers?

- A.a boat trip
- B.a barbecue
- C.a party

Test2–listening–part3

Questions 21-25

What is Rosie and Colin's opinion about each of the following aspects of human geography?

Choose **FIVE** answers from the box and write the correct letter, **A–G**, next to Questions 21–25.

Aspects of human geography

21. Population

22. Health

23. Economies

24. Culture

25. Poverty

A. The information given about this was too vague.

B. This may not be relevant to their course.

C. This will involve only a small number of statistics.

D. It will be easy to find facts about this.

E. The facts about this may not be reliable.

F. No useful research has been done on this.

G. The information provided about this was interesting.

Questions 26-30

Choose the correct letter, A, B or C.

26 Rosie says that in her own city the main problem is

A.crime.

B.housing.

C.unemployment.

27 What recent additions to the outskirts of their cities are both students happy about?

A.conference centres

B.sports centres

C.retail centres

28 The students agree that developing disused industrial sites may

A.have unexpected costs.

B.damage the urban environment.

C.destroy valuable historical buildings.

29 The students will mention Masdar City as an example of an attempt to achieve

A.daily collections for waste recycling.

B.sustainable energy use.

C.free transport for everyone.

30 When discussing the ecotown of Greenhill Abbots, Colin is uncertain about

A.what its objectives were.

B.why there was opposition to it.

C.how much of it has actually been built.

Test2–listening–part4

Questions 31-40

Complete the notes below.

Write **ONE WORD ONLY** for each answer.

Developing food trends

- The growth in interest in food fashions started with of food being shared on social media.
- The UK food industry is constantly developing products which are new or different.
- Influencers on social media become 'ambassadors' for a brand.
- Sales of food brands have grown rapidly this way.
- Supermarkets track demand for ingredients on social media.
- Famous are influential.

Marketing campaigns

- The avocado:
 - were invited to visit growers in South Africa.
 - Advertising focused on its benefits.
- Oat milk:
 - A Swedish brand's media campaign received publicity by upsetting competitors.
 - Promotion in the USA through shops reduced the need for advertising.
 - It appealed to consumers who are concerned about the .
- Norwegian skrei:
 - has helped strengthen the of Norwegian seafood.

Ethical concerns

- Quinoa:
 - Its success led to an increase in its .
 - Overuse of resources resulted in poor quality .

答案:

1、break 2、time 3、shower 4、money 5、memory 6、lifting 7、fall 8、taxi 9、insurance 10、stress

11、D

12、I

13、H

14、E

15、A

16、B

17.B

18.A

19.B

20.A

21、D 22、G 23、B 24、A 25、E

26.C 27.A 28.A 29.B 30.C

31、photos|photographs|pictures 32、vegan 33、chefs|cooks 34、journalists|reporters 35、health 36、
coffee 37、environment 38、reputation 39、price|cost 40、soil

Test2–reading–passage1

Manatees

Manatees, also known as sea cows, are aquatic mammals that belong to a group of animals called Sirenia. This group also contains dugongs. Dugongs and manatees look quite alike – they are similar in size, colour and shape, and both have flexible flippers for forelimbs. However, the manatee has a broad, rounded tail, whereas the dugong’s is fluked, like that of a whale. There are three species of manatees: the West Indian manatee (*Trichechus manatus*), the African manatee (*Trichechus senegalensis*) and the Amazonian manatee (*Trichechus inunguis*).

Unlike most mammals, manatees have only six bones in their neck – most others, including humans and giraffes, have seven. This short neck allows a manatee to move its head up and down, but not side to side. To see something on its left or its right, a manatee must turn its entire body, steering with its flippers. Manatees have pectoral flippers but no back limbs, only a tail for propulsion. They do have pelvic bones, however – a leftover from their evolution from a four-legged to a fully aquatic animal. Manatees share some visual similarities to elephants. Like elephants, manatees have thick, wrinkled skin. They also have some hairs covering their bodies which help them sense vibrations in the water around them.

Seagrasses and other marine plants make up most of a manatee’s diet. Manatees spend about eight hours each day grazing and uprooting plants. They eat up to 15%

of their weight in food each day. African manatees are omnivorous – studies have shown that molluscs and fish make up a small part of their diets. West Indian and Amazonian manatees are both herbivores.

Manatees' teeth are all molars – flat, rounded teeth for grinding food. Due to manatees' abrasive aquatic plant diet, these teeth get worn down and they eventually fall out, so they continually grow new teeth that get pushed forward to replace the ones they lose. Instead of having incisors to grasp their food, manatees have lips which function like a pair of hands to help tear food away from the seafloor.

Manatees are fully aquatic, but as mammals, they need to come up to the surface to breathe. When awake, they typically surface every two to four minutes, but they can hold their breath for much longer. Adult manatees sleep underwater for 10–12 hours a day, but they come up for air every 15–20 minutes. Active manatees need to breathe more frequently. It's thought that manatees use their muscular diaphragm and breathing to adjust their buoyancy. They may use diaphragm contractions to compress and store gas in folds in their large intestine to help them float.

The West Indian manatee reaches about 3.5 metres long and weighs on average around 500 kilogrammes. It moves between fresh water and salt water, taking advantage of coastal mangroves and coral reefs, rivers, lakes and inland lagoons. There are two subspecies of West Indian manatee: the Antillean manatee is found in waters from the Bahamas to Brazil, whereas the Florida manatee is found in US waters, although some individuals have been recorded in the Bahamas. In winter, the Florida manatee is typically restricted to Florida. When the ambient water

temperature drops below 20°C, it takes refuge in naturally and artificially warmed water, such as at the warm-water outfalls from powerplants.

The African manatee is also about 3.5 metres long and found in the sea along the west coast of Africa, from Mauritania down to Angola. The species also makes use of rivers, with the mammals seen in landlocked countries such as Mali and Niger.

The Amazonian manatee is the smallest species, though it is still a big animal. It grows to about 2.5 metres long and 350 kilogrammes. Amazonian manatees favour calm, shallow waters that are above 23°C. This species is found in fresh water in the Amazon Basin in Brazil, as well as in Colombia, Ecuador and Peru.

All three manatee species are endangered or at a heightened risk of extinction. The African manatee and Amazonian manatee are both listed as Vulnerable by the International Union for Conservation of Nature (IUCN). It is estimated that 140,000 Amazonian manatees were killed between 1935 and 1954 for their meat, fat and skin, with the latter used to make leather. In more recent years, African manatee decline has been tied to incidental capture in fishing nets and hunting. Manatee hunting is now illegal in every country the African species is found in.

The two subspecies of West Indian manatee are listed as Endangered by the IUCN. Both are also expected to undergo a decline of 20% over the next 40 years. A review of almost 1,800 cases of entanglement in fishing nets and of plastic consumption among marine mammals in US waters from 2009 to 2020 found that at least 700 cases involved manatees. The chief cause of death in Florida manatees is

boat strikes. However, laws in certain parts of Florida now limit boat speeds during winter, allowing slow-moving manatees more time to respond.

Questions 1–6

Complete the notes below.

Choose **ONE WORD AND/OR A NUMBER** from the passage for each answer.

Manatees

Appearance

- look similar to dugongs, but with a differently shaped

1

Movement

- have fewer neck bones than most mammals

- need to use their
- 2
- to help to turn their bodies around in order to look sideways

- sense vibrations in the water by means of

3

on their skin

Feeding

- eat mainly aquatic vegetation, such as

4

.

· grasp and pull up plants with their 5 .

Breathing

· come to the surface for air every 2-4 minutes when awake and every 15-20 while sleeping

· may regulate the 6 of their bodies by using muscles of diaphragm to store air internally

Questions 7–13

Do the following statements agree with the information given in Reading Passage 1?

TRUE if the statement agrees with the information

FALSE if the statement contradicts the information

NOT GIVEN if there is no information on this

7. West Indian manatees can be found in a variety of different aquatic habitats.

8. The Florida manatee lives in warmer waters than the Antillean manatee.

9. The African manatee's range is limited to coastal waters between the West African countries of Mauritania and Angola.

10. The extent of the loss of Amazonian manatees in the mid-twentieth century was only revealed many years later.

11. It is predicted that West Indian manatee populations will fall in the coming decades.

12. The risk to manatees from entanglement and plastic consumption increased significantly in the period 2009–2020.

13. There is some legislation in place which aims to reduce the likelihood of boat strikes on manatees in Florida.

Test2–reading–passage2

Procrastination

A psychologist explains why we put off important tasks and how we can break this habit

A Procrastination is the habit of delaying a necessary task, usually by focusing on less urgent, more enjoyable, and easier activities instead. We all do it from time to time. We might be composing a message to a friend who we have to let down, or putting together an important report for college or work; we're doing our best to avoid doing the job at hand, but deep down we know that we should just be getting on with it. Unfortunately, berating ourselves won't stop us procrastinating again. In fact, it's one of the worst things we can do. This matters because, as my research shows, procrastination doesn't just waste time, but is actually linked to other problems, too.

B Contrary to popular belief, procrastination is not due to laziness or poor time management. Scientific studies suggest procrastination is, in fact, caused by poor mood management. This makes sense if we consider that people are more likely to put off starting or completing tasks that they are really not keen to do. If just thinking about the task threatens our sense of self-worth or makes us anxious, we will be more likely to put it off. Research involving brain imaging has found that areas of the brain linked to detection of threats and emotion regulation are actually different in people who chronically procrastinate compared to those who don't procrastinate frequently.

C Tasks that are emotionally loaded or difficult, such as preparing for exams, are prime candidates for procrastination. People with low self-esteem are more likely to procrastinate. Another group of people who tend to procrastinate are perfectionists, who worry their work will be judged harshly by others. We know that if we don't finish that report or complete those home repairs, then what we did can't be evaluated. When we avoid such tasks, we also avoid the negative emotions associated with them. This is rewarding, and it conditions us to use procrastination to repair our mood. If we engage in more enjoyable tasks instead, we get another mood boost. In the long run, however, procrastination isn't an effective way of managing emotions. The 'mood repair' we experience is temporary. Afterwards, people tend to be left with a sense of guilt that not only increases their negative mood, but also reinforces their tendency to procrastinate.

D So why is this such a problem? When most people think of the costs of procrastination, they think of the toll on productivity. For example, studies have shown that procrastination negatively impacts on student performance. But putting off reading textbooks and writing essays may affect other areas of students' lives. In one study of over 3,000 German students over a six-month period, those who reported procrastinating over their university work were also more likely to engage in study-related misconduct, such as cheating and plagiarism. But the behaviour that procrastination was most closely linked with was using fraudulent excuses to get deadline extensions. Other research shows that employees on average spend almost a quarter of their workday procrastinating, and again this is linked with negative outcomes. In fact, in one US survey of over 22,000 employees, participants who said they regularly procrastinated had less annual income and less employment

stability. For every one-point increase on a measure of chronic procrastination, annual income decreased by US\$15,000.

E Procrastination also correlates with serious health and well-being problems. A tendency to procrastinate is linked to poor mental health, including higher levels of depression and anxiety. Across numerous studies, I've found people who regularly procrastinate report a greater number of health issues, such as headaches, flu and colds, and digestive issues. They also experience higher levels of stress and poor sleep quality. They are less likely to practise healthy behaviours, such as eating a healthy diet and regularly exercising, and use destructive coping strategies to manage their stress. In one study of over 700 people, I found people prone to procrastination had a 63% greater risk of poor heart health after accounting for other personality traits and demographics.

F Finding better ways of managing our emotions is one route out of the vicious cycle of procrastination. An important first step is to manage our environment and how we view the task. There are a number of evidence-based strategies that can help us fend off distractions that can occupy our minds when we should be focusing on the thing we should be getting on with. For example, reminding ourselves about why the task is important and valuable can increase positive feelings towards it. Forgiving ourselves and feeling compassion when we procrastinate can help break the procrastination cycle. We should admit that we feel bad, but not be overly critical of ourselves. We should remind ourselves that we're not the first person to procrastinate, nor the last. Doing this can take the edge off the negative feelings we

have about ourselves when we procrastinate. This can all make it easier to get back on track.

Questions 14–16

Reading Passage 2 has six paragraphs, **A–F**.

Which paragraph contains the following information?

NB You may use any letter more than once.

Column 1	A	B	C	D	E	F
14. mention of false assumptions about why people procrastinate						
15. reference to the realisation that others also procrastinate						
16. neurological evidence of a link between procrastination and emotion						

Questions 17–22

Complete the summary below.

Choose **ONE WORD ONLY** from the passage for each answer.

What makes us procrastinate?

Many people think that procrastination is the result of .

Others believe it to be the result of an inability to organise time efficiently.

But scientific studies suggest that procrastination is actually due to poor mood management. The tasks we are most likely to put off are those that could damage our self-esteem or cause us to feel when we think about them. Research comparing chronic procrastinators with other people even found differences in the brain regions associated with regulating emotions and identifying .

Emotionally loaded and difficult tasks often cause us to procrastinate. Getting ready to take might be a typical example of one such task.

People who are likely to procrastinate tend to be either or those with low self-esteem.

Procrastination is only a short-term measure for managing emotions. It's often followed by a feeling of , which worsens our mood and leads to more procrastination.

Questions 23 and 24
Choose TWO letters, A–E.

23 - 24 Which TWO comparisons between employees who often procrastinate and those who do not are mentioned in the text?

A. Their salaries are lower.

- B. The quality of their work is inferior.
- C. They don't keep their jobs for as long.
- D. They don't enjoy their working lives as much.
- E. They have poorer relationships with colleagues.

Questions 25 and 26

Choose TWO letters, A–E.

25 - 26 Which TWO recommendations for getting out of a cycle of procrastination does the writer give?

- A. not judging ourselves harshly
- B. setting ourselves manageable aims
- C. rewarding ourselves for tasks achieved
- D. prioritising tasks according to their importance
- E. avoiding things that stop us concentrating on our tasks

Test2–reading–passage3

Invasion of the Robot Umpires

A few years ago, Fred DeJesus from Brooklyn, New York became the first umpire in a minor league baseball game to use something called the Automated Ball-Strike System (ABS), often referred to as the 'robo-umpire'. Instead of making any judgments himself about a strike*, DeJesus had decisions fed to him through an earpiece, connected to a modified missile-tracking system. The contraption looked like a large black pizza box with one glowing green eye; it was mounted above the press stand.

Major League Baseball (MLB), who had commissioned the system, wanted human umpires to announce the calls, just as they would have done in the past. When the first pitch came in, a recorded voice told DeJesus it was a strike. Previously, calling

a strike was a judgment call on the part of the umpire. Even if the batter does not hit the ball, a pitch that passes through the 'strike zone' (an imaginary zone about seventeen inches wide, stretching from the batter's knees to the middle of his chest) is considered a strike. During that first game, when DeJesus announced calls, there was no heckling and no shouted disagreement. Nobody said a word.

For a hundred and fifty years or so, the strike zone has been the game's animating force—countless arguments between a team's manager and the umpire have taken place over its boundaries and whether a ball had crossed through it. The rules of play have evolved in various stages. Today, everyone knows that you may scream your disagreement in an umpire's face, but you must never shout personal abuse at them or touch them. That's a no-no. When the robo-umpires came, however, the arguments stopped.

During the first robo-umpire season, players complained about some strange calls. In response, MLB decided to tweak the dimensions of the zone, and the following year the consensus was that ABS is profoundly consistent. MLB says the device is near-perfect, precise to within fractions of an inch. "It'll reduce controversy in the game, and be good for the game," says Rob Manfred, who is Commissioner for MLB. But the question is whether controversy is worth reducing, or whether it is the sign of a human hand.

A human, at least, yells back. When I spoke with Frank Viola, a coach for a North Carolina team, he said that ABS works as designed, but that it was also unforgiving and pedantic, almost legalistic. "Manfred is a lawyer," Viola noted. Some pitchers have complained that, compared with a human's, the robot's strike zone seems too

precise. Viola was once a major-league player himself. When he was pitching, he explained, umpires rewarded skill. “Throw it where you aimed, and it would be a strike, even if it was an inch or two outside. There was a dialogue between pitcher and umpire.”

The executive tasked with running the experiment for MLB is Morgan Sword, who’s in charge of baseball operations. According to Sword, ABS was part of a larger project to make baseball more exciting since executives are terrified of losing younger fans, as has been the case with horse racing and boxing. He explains how they began the process by asking fans what version of baseball they found most exciting. The results showed that everyone wanted more action: more hits, more defense, more baserunning. This type of baseball essentially hasn’t existed since the 1960s, when the hundred-mile-an-hour fastball, which is difficult to hit and control, entered the game. It flattened the game into strikeouts, walks, and home runs—a type of play lacking much action.

Sword’s team brainstormed potential fixes. Any rule that existed, they talked about changing—from changing the bats to changing the geometry of the field. But while all of these were ruled out as potential fixes, ABS was seen as a perfect vehicle for change. According to Sword, once you get the technology right, you can load any strike zone you want into the system. “It might be a triangle, or a blob, or something shaped like Texas. Over time, as baseball evolves, ABS can allow the zone to change with it.”

“In the past twenty years, sports have moved away from judgment calls. Soccer has Video Assistant Referees (for offside decisions, for example). Tennis has Hawk-Eye

(for line calls, for example). For almost a decade, baseball has used instant replay on the base paths. This is widely liked, even if the precision can sometimes cause problems. But these applications deal with something physical: bases, lines, goals. The boundaries of action are precise, delineated like the keys of a piano. This is not the case with ABS and the strike zone. Historically, a certain discretion has been appreciated.”

I decided to email Alva Noë, a professor at Berkeley University and a baseball fan, for his opinion. “Hardly a day goes by that I don’t wake up and run through the reasons that this [robo-umpires] is such a terrible idea,” he replied. He later told me, “This is part of a movement to use algorithms to take the hard choices of living out of life.” Perhaps he’s right. We watch baseball to kill time, not to maximize it. Some players I have met take a dissenting stance toward the robots too, believing that accuracy is not the answer. According to Joe Russo, who plays for a New Jersey team, “With technology, people just want everything to be perfect. That’s not reality. I think perfect would be weird. Your teams are always winning, work is always just great, there’s always money in your pocket, your car never breaks down. What is there to talk about?”

* strike: a strike is when the batter swings at a ball and misses or when the batter does not swing at a ball that passes through the strike zone.

Questions 27–32

Do the following statements agree with the claims of the writer in Reading Passage 3?

- | | |
|-----------|--|
| YES | if the statement agrees with the claims of the writer |
| NO | if the statement contradicts the claims of the writer |
| NOT GIVEN | if it is impossible to say what the writer thinks about this |

27. When DeJesus first used ABS, he shared decision-making about strikes with it.
28. MLB considered it necessary to amend the size of the strike zone when criticisms were received from players.
29. MLB is keen to justify the money spent on improving the accuracy of ABS's calculations.
30. The hundred-mile-an-hour fastball led to a more exciting style of play.
31. The differing proposals for alterations to the baseball bat led to fierce debate on Sword's team.
32. ABS makes changes to the shape of the strike zone feasible.

Questions 33–37

Complete the summary using the list of phrases, A–H, below.

Calls by the umpire

Even after ABS was developed, MLB still wanted human umpires to shout out decisions as

they had in their 33 . The umpire's job had, at one time,

required a 34 about whether a ball was a strike. A ball is

considered a strike when the batter does not hit it and it crosses through a

35 extending approximately from the batter's knee to his

chest.

In the past, 36 over strike calls were not uncommon, but

today everyone accepts the complete ban on pushing or shoving the umpire. One

difference, however, is that during the first game DeJesus used ABS, strike calls were met

with 37 .

A. pitch boundary

B. numerous disputes

C. team tactics

D. subjective assessment

E. widespread approval

F. former roles

G. total silence

H. perceived area

Questions 38–40

Choose the correct letter, A, B, C or D.

38. What does the writer suggest about ABS in the fifth paragraph?

- A. It is bound to make key decisions that are wrong.
- B. It may reduce some of the appeal of the game.
- C. It will lead to the disappearance of human umpires.
- D. It may increase calls for the rules of baseball to be changed.

39. Morgan Sword says that the introduction of ABS

- A. was regarded as an experiment without a guaranteed outcome.
- B. was intended to keep up with developments in other sports.
- C. was a response to changing attitudes about the role of sport.
- D. was an attempt to ensure baseball retained a young audience.

40. Why does the writer include the views of Noë and Russo?

- A. to show that attitudes to technology vary widely
- B. to argue that people have unrealistic expectations of sport
- C. to indicate that accuracy is not the same thing as enjoyment
- D. to suggest that the number of baseball fans needs to increase

答案:

1、tail 2、flippers 3、hair 4、seagrasses 5、lips 6、buoyancy

7. T 8. NG 9.F 10.NG 11.T 12.NG 13.T

14、B 15、F 16、B

17、laziness 18、anxious 19、threats 20、exams 21、perfectionists 22、guilt

23-24.AC 25-26.AE

27.N 28.Y 29.NG 30.N 31.NG 32.Y

33、F 34、D 35、H 36、B 37、G

38.B 39.D 40.C

Test2–writing–task1

You should spend about 20 minutes on this task.

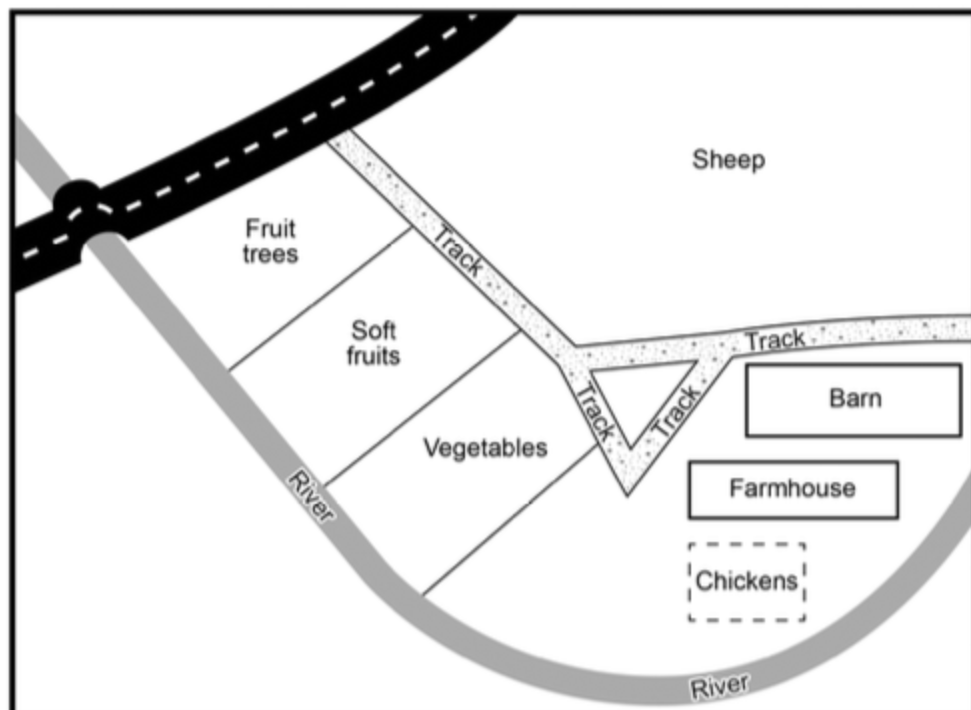
The plans below show the site of a farm in 1950 and the same site today.

Summarise the information by selecting and reporting the main features, and make comparisons where relevant.

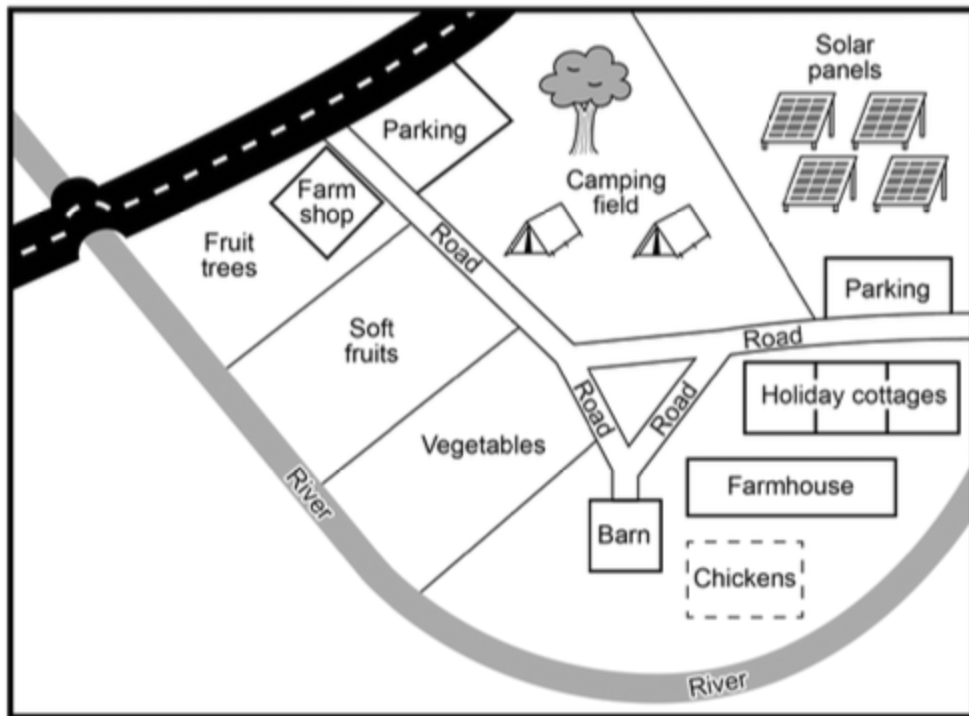
Write at least 150 words.

Beechwood Farm

1950



Today



Test2–writing–task2

You should spend about 40 minutes on this task. Write about the following topic:

In many countries, primary and secondary schools close for two months or more in the summer holidays.

What is the value of long school holidays?

What are the arguments in favour of shorter school holidays?

Give reasons for your answer and include any relevant examples from your own knowledge or experience.

Write at least 250 words.

小作文【考生作文】

This is an answer written by a candidate who achieved a **Band 6.0** score.

If we look at the pictures we will see how Beechwood Farm has changed along the time.

Years ago, in 1950, Beechwood Farm was a typical farm. A track crossed the farm, so farmers could reach the barn and the farmhouse passing by the fruit trees, and the place where the soft fruits and the vegetables were growing. At the opposite side of the track, was the field where the sheep were situated. That was close to the farmhouse, where chickens were also situated. All the farm was surrounded, at the south, by a river.

Nowadays, the farm has suffered changes. Modern life brought to the farm some needs to survive. The main change was the road that replaced the track. Now it is easier to arrive any place in the farm.

There is a parking zone near the road where the sheep used to eat grass. We can also find a camping field and Solar panels in that zone.

Another parking zone can be found where the solar panels are situated.

Just in front of the first parking zone we can see a farm shop. The old barn was replaced for a holiday cottages, and relocated close to the chickens, near the river.

Lot of things have changed since 1950, and Beechwood Farm is not an exception. Modern times had come, and everyone had to be adjusted to new ways of living. We still have Beechwood Farm, but a new sophisticated and modern one.

【考官评语】

Here is the examiner's comment:

This response addresses all of the changes illustrated in the farm plans. The writer describes how the farm looked in 1950, then moves on to the present-day plan. There is an overview in the last paragraph [Lot of things have changed since 1950, and Beechwood Farm ... a new sophisticated and modern one] but it does not mention the link to attracting visitors, so is not complete.

Information is generally arranged coherently. The first two paragraphs cover the 1950s site, with the remainder focused on the farm today. There is evidence of linking expressions [At the opposite side | That | Nowadays]; however, there is a lack of reference, resulting in repetition [farm | zone].

Vocabulary is generally good [parking zone | relocated | exception | adjusted | sophisticated] but errors remain [along the time / over time | tipycal | sourrounded | Nowadays | easier | cottoges].

Grammatical range is mixed. There are examples of complex sentence forms, including [If] clauses and modal forms [could reach | can also find] but there are also a range of errors which preclude a higher score.

To improve the score, an overview that summarises the main changes should be added. It would also be beneficial to show greater accuracy in vocabulary and use of grammatical structures.

Example overview

These plans of the farm illustrate the updated facilities that have been added since 1950, which include accommodation, power generation and other additions to appeal to visitors and holidaymakers.

【参考翻译】

这篇写作回应涵盖了农场规划图所展示的所有变化。作者先描述了 1950 年时农场的样子，接着介绍了现在的规划。在最后一段有一个总体概述句：“Lot of things have changed since 1950, and Beechwood Farm ... a new sophisticated and modern one”，但它没有提到吸引游客这一关键点，因此不够完整。

信息整体上安排得比较有条理。前两段描述的是 1950 年的农场布局，其余部分则集中介绍如今的农场。文中使用了一些连接表达 [At the opposite side | That | Nowadays], 但缺乏指代手段，导致一些词汇被重复使用 [farm | zone]。

词汇方面总体表现不错，出现了一些较高级的词语和短语 [parking zone | relocated | exception | adjusted | sophisticated], 但也存在一些拼写和用词错误 [along the time / over time | tipycal | sourrounded | Nowadeys | easier | cottoges]。

语法结构方面呈现了一定的多样性。文中出现了复合句结构, 包括条件状语从句 [If] 和情态动词形式 [could reach | can also find], 但也存在不少语法错误, 影响了得分。若想提升分数, 考生应在文章开头或结尾加入一个更完整的总体概述, 概括主要变化。同时, 在词汇准确性与语法结构运用方面也应更加严谨。

参考概述示例：

这两幅农场规划图展示了自 1950 年以来新增的现代化设施，包括住宿区、发电站以及其他为吸引游客和度假者而建的新区域。

大作文【考生作文】

This is an answer written by a candidate who achieved a **Band 7.0** score.

In today's world, education is a must to every child and individual across every country. The duration of summer holidays became a major thing in terms of

priority in some countries like in middle eastern location. Where as cold countries which experience long winters have concentrated less on summer holidays giving only few weeks for summer vacations.

On the otherside, a regular family would like to spend most of the time in summer holidays by travelling to their homeland, meeting their relatives and seek long durations for summer, so that children can spend valuable time with cousins and relatives making valuable memories. On the other hand, some parents who work 365 days would find it difficult to take care of children during summer holidays as they have to work and prefer shorter period of holidays.

This has become a major problem and is affecting children in a bad way.

Childhood is to cherish some good valuable memories along with studies. Longer summer breaks allow the children to make time to visit family relatives and this early relationship helps to maintain a stronger bond for the rest of the life. Once they are out of school, they have to work and make a living for themselves where they won't find time for their loved ones.

Coming to shorter school holidays, they help the children from falling back in studies (or) having interest. With longer duration of holidays children take a lot of time to get back their concentration after the school starts. It has both positive and negative side to it. Shorter school holidays help the student to maintain concentration, performance but at the same time they won't form special bonds which are really important.

From my perspective, maintaining strong relationship bonds is more important than just education which requires a longer duration of summer holidays.

【考官评语】

Here is the examiner's comment:

This is an appropriate response, with a series of ideas for each part, presented effectively. It starts with a note that different countries have different patterns. The value of long holidays include families being able to travel and spend time with relatives, as once children leave school, they won't have the free time to develop these strong bonds. The arguments for shorter holidays mention families where parents work and cannot take so much leave, and that it helps children not to fall behind in their studies. The candidate concludes that stronger family bonds are more important, so longer holidays are best. There is some minor repetition in the ideas presented.

Ideas are logically organised, and cohesive devices are varied. Reference is used [This | they | their] but some inaccuracy in linking devices [Where as | On the otherside | Coming to], and some repetition [relatives | valuable] limits the rating in this area.

Vocabulary is a strength, with frequent high-level content and some skilful collocation [spend valuable time | affecting children | maintain a stronger bond]. Some errors remain [falling back / falling behind]. Grammatical structures are also varied and show some flexibility and some multi-clause sentences. However, most sentences are not error-free, as there are slips with prepositions [to every child / for every child | in holiday / on holiday] and plurals [shorter period of holidays | side / sides] and some missing punctuation.

To achieve a higher score, the candidate could explore the 'value of long holidays' and 'arguments for shorter holidays' in more depth. A greater degree of accuracy in vocabulary and grammatical structures would also improve the score.

【参考翻译】

这是一篇恰当完成任务的作文，每一部分内容都提出了系列观点，并表达得较为有效。文章开头指出不同国家有不同的假期模式。接着分别讨论了长假的价值，包括家庭可以一起出行、与亲人共度时光，因为一旦孩子离开学校，就没有那么多自由时间来建立这些深厚的情感联系。关于短假期的优势，作者也提到了一些现实情况，例如父母工作繁忙、无法请太多假，同时短假期也有助于孩子不落下学业。最后考生总结认为，家庭情感联系更为重要，因此更支持较长的假期。不过文中存在一些观点上的轻微重复。

文章思路组织清晰有逻辑，连接词使用多样。文中使用了一些指代手段 [This | they | their]，但在部分连接词的使用上存在错误 [Where as | On the otherside | Coming to]，同时某些词汇（如 relatives 和 valuable）重复使用，影响了这一部分的得分。

词汇方面是该文的一大优势，高频词汇使用频繁，并出现了不少较高级的搭配 [spend valuable time | affecting children | maintain a stronger bond]。但仍有一些拼写或用词错误 [falling back / falling behind]。

语法结构也展现出一定的多样性，体现出一定的灵活性和多从句结构的运用。然而，大部分句子并非完全无误，存在介词使用不当 [to every child / for every child | in holiday / on holiday]、复数形式错误 [shorter period of holidays | side / sides] 以及标点缺失等问题。

若想获得更高分数，考生可以在“长假的价值”和“短假的优势”两个部分展开更深入的分析。同时，在词汇和语法结构的使用上提高准确性，也将有助于提升整体得分。

Test2–speaking

Test 2-Part 1

1. What's your favourite fruit?
2. Are there any kinds of fruit that you don't like eating?
3. Do you like eating cooked food that has fruit in it?
4. Where's the best place to buy fruit where you live?

Test 2-Part 2

Describe a time when you changed a plan you had made.

You should say:

what your original plan was

why you changed it

what new plan you made

and explain how you felt about changing your plan.

Test 2-Part 3

Please answer the questions 1-6

1. What kinds of plans do friends make together?
2. Do you think it's better to discuss future plans with friends or with family?
3. When making plans for the future, is it important not to copy friends?
 1. When people are choosing what to study, how important is it that their course should lead directly to a career?
 2. Why is it a good idea to get some work experience before deciding on a future career?
 3. How easy do you think it is for people to change from one career to another?

part1

1. Oh, definitely tangerines! They're the perfect combo of sweetness and tanginess, and they're super juicy when you peel them. Plus, the bright orange colour is an instant mood booster for me. What appeals to me the most is that they're not as overpriced as other trendy "superfruits" these days, yet they're packed with vitamin C. That's why they've always been my go-to fruit.

2. Well, if you ask me, I'd say durian. I know it's widely known as the "king of fruits" and loved by many of my friends, but I just can't stand its pungent smell—it reminds me of rotting onions. The texture's even worse; it's like swallowing sweetened clotted cream mixed with stringy bits. Honestly, even durian-flavoured candies freak me out!

3. Personally, it's not my cup of tea. For example, in China there's a dish called pineapple pork which is a famous Cantonese dish. I've tried it a few times, but I just can't get used to the way warm, mushy fruit clashes with salty flavours—it feels wrong to me. If you ask my opinion, fruits are meant to be eaten raw to get their natural zing.

4. If I'm in a rush, I'll just order fruit through grocery delivery apps. They'll leave it at my doorstep within an hour! But for better quality and prices, I go to a nearby wholesale market. The produce there is freshly harvested, and there's a much wider variety. Plus, I actually enjoy haggling with the vendors—it adds to the experience.

part2

Let me tell you about my snorkelling trip that got canceled in Phuket last monsoon season.

I mean, my original plan was this meticulously organised 3-day island-hopping adventure, complete with underwater photography sessions and sunset cruises. Everything looked perfect, at least on paper.

To be honest, the first day was excellent—turquoise waters, powdery beaches, everything went swimmingly. Unfortunately, on day two, Mother Nature threw a spanner in our plans. Out of nowhere, a tropical storm blew in – winds picking up like angry spirits, and then the rain started bucketing down mercilessly. Frankly, the waves became wild horses galloping across the sea. At that point, our boat captain called off everything, saying, "It never rains but it pours"—which, in hindsight, was spot-on. I slumped into disappointment, staring at my futile preparations. Had I known earlier, I'd have cancelled this trip altogether.

Thankfully, here's the silver lining—our resort offered complimentary massage therapies. That said, the therapeutic experience proved magical, melting away resentment like ice in sunshine. What's more, over ginger tea, I swapped stories with globetrotters whose adventures made mine pale in comparison.

Now, while snorkelling remains firmly on my bucket list, this detour taught me something crucial—life's best unplanned moments often arrive unexpectedly. In other words, when Plan A sinks, Plan B may come to your rescue. Hopefully next time, I'll remember this lesson when travel plans go sideways.

part3

1. Well, friends usually plan various leisure activities. They might go shopping, watch movies, or plan weekend getaways and concert outings. On top of that, they often engage in hobby-based stuff. For instance, they could join a hiking club, train for a marathon, or attend a painting workshop. Just as the saying goes, “Birds of a feather flock together.” Moreover, friends also make elaborate plans to celebrate special moments. They might throw surprise parties for each other’s birthdays, or organize themed gatherings to mark important milestones, such as graduations or job promotions.

2. It really depends. Generally speaking, friends tend to relate better to personal choices like career shifts or dating dilemmas. For example, if you’re torn between settling down and focusing on your career, friends might give unbiased advice, whereas parents would probably push for marriage. That said, when it comes to major moves like relocating abroad, cutting off contact with your family isn’t a wise option, as you need their support in many ways, such as practical input on visa arrangements, financial support, or even childcare help. At the end of the day, it’s a balancing act.

3. Well, definitely. To be honest, it’s completely normal to get ideas from friends when planning ahead. I mean, seeing people you trust do something similar does give that initial sense of security. But the thing is, if we just mirror their choices without proper reflection, things can get messy quickly. Take degree choices for instance: I’ve noticed that loads of students go into fields like marketing or computer science simply because their social circle does. The problem kicks in when they realise their strengths don’t align with the coursework at all; you can imagine the stress that follows. That’s why I firmly believe that when it comes to major life decisions, we should build plans around our natural talents and core values. After all, we’re all wired differently.

1. Well, that’s a classic dilemma. Think about it: how many of us end up in jobs exactly matching our degree titles? Don’t get me wrong: career-driven degrees like engineering are gold for giving that quick start with their hands-on training and internships. But take philosophy graduates, for example. On paper, they seem job-ready for nothing specific, yet some of them end up thriving in business or tech. I suppose the reason is that those abstract courses wire your brain to tackle problems in ways that no technical manual can teach. So ultimately, while job-specific skills get you through the door, it’s the transferable skills that help you climb the career ladder.

2. Well, here’s the thing about internships—they let you test the waters without signing your life away. Many young graduates switch tracks after realising the fact that they don’t really match their first career options. Additionally, no lectures or textbooks can teach you the messy stuff, like calming down a furious client or decoding your boss’s cryptic emails; these are things you can only learn through real-world experience. Lastly, even the most mundane tasks, like making coffee runs and handling spreadsheets, can enhance your CV and help you stand out in the job market later on.

3. To be honest, it’s no walk in the park. As the saying goes, different fields are worlds apart. So, embarking on a brand-new career means starting from scratch: you have to acquire new certifications, adapt to unfamiliar work cultures, and rebuild professional networks; all of which require dedication and willpower. But on the flip side, it’s liberating. I’ve seen people thrive after escaping dead-end jobs. So yeah, it’s tough but doable with grit.